

English Language Centre
ELC3524 Professional Communication for Computing Students
2025-2026 Semester 1 2 credits
Information for Students

I. Objectives

This subject develops the English language skills and communication skills required to communicate effectively in professional contexts. The subject aims to enhance students' ability to express themselves clearly, select language appropriate to the context, and influence opinions persuasively.

In striving to achieve the interrelated objectives, attention will be given to the university's goal of developing students as critical thinkers, effective communicators, innovative problem solvers and socially responsible global citizens.

II. Learning outcomes

Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to:

- a) Apply appropriate language and communication strategies when communicating discipline knowledge to different professional audiences.
- b) Present ideas clearly, persuasively, and professionally in both spoken and written discourses.
- c) Demonstrate critical analysis and reflection on the use of language and communication strategies through reviewing written and spoken output.

III. Learning schedule

Week	Topic	Milestone Achievement Tasks (15%)
Week 1	Unit 1: Introducing Yourself - share experience, expertise and interests - identify a key message you would like to share about yourself - analyse scripts and outline your message	Nil
Week 2	Unit 1: Telling Your Story - write an engaging script about yourself using storytelling skills, communication strategies and persuasive language features - speak with clarity (including clear pronunciation), fluency and confidence	MA Task 1 Self-Introduction Script Outline <i>Submission: Before Week 3</i> <i>Activity: Week 3 in-class</i>
Week 3		
Week 4	Unit 1: Visual Storytelling - review and improve the effectiveness of the use of storytelling skills, communication strategies and persuasive language features in your script - analyse videos and identify effective verbal and non-verbal interactive strategies, as well as digital literacy skills	MA Task 2 Self-Introduction Storyboard and Video Clip <i>Submission: Before Week 5</i> <i>Activity: Week 5 in-class</i>
Week 5		
Week 6	Unit 2: Introduction and Brainstorming - transition from Video Portfolio to Writing Professional Profiles - form groups and start brainstorming a project idea - analyse proposals	Nil
<u>Assessment 1 Individual Video Portfolio: Who You Are and Your Aspirations (40%)</u> <i>Video length: Minimum 2 minutes; Maximum 2 minutes 30 seconds</i> <i>Submission: within 48 hours of Week 6 Class (Link on Blackboard)</i>		

Week 7	Unit 2: Researching Your Idea - find, evaluate, select, and integrate credible and relevant information to support your idea	MA Task 3 Initial Proposal Idea Outline <i>In-class: Week 7</i>
Week 8	Initial Project Idea Sharing - enhance clarity and persuasiveness by using storytelling skills, verbal and non-verbal communication skills and visual aids - establish credibility and professionalism by effectively introducing yourself and referring to sound and well-presented research	MA Task 4 Pitching Your Idea <i>In-class: Week 8</i>
Week 9	Unit 2: Introducing Your Idea - analyse samples – <i>Executive Summary, Introduction, Goal and Objectives</i> - develop awareness of persuasive writing strategies - introduce idea clearly and persuasively in writing	Nil
Week 10	Unit 2: Justifying Your Idea - evaluate samples – <i>Current Situation</i> - review research and academic writing skills - justify needs, problems and opportunities clearly and convincingly in writing	Nil
Week 11	Unit 2: Explaining Your Idea - analyse samples - <i>Product Overview and Technical Details</i> - explain how an idea works clearly and comprehensibly - develop awareness of writing strategies	Nil
Lesson 12	Unit 2: Persuading Your Reader - analyse samples – <i>Benefits</i> - persuade the reader that the proposed idea will make a difference	Nil
	Q&A based Consultation	
Lesson 13	Finalising Your Writing and Reflecting on your learning journey - discuss and identify areas of improvement - finalise proposal based on peer-review	MA Task 5 Complete Proposal Draft and Peer Review <i>Submission: Before Week 13 class</i> <i>Activity: Week 13 in-class</i>
<u>Assessment 2 Group Project Proposal (45%)</u> <i>Word Limit: Minimum 2000; Maximum 2500</i> <i>Schedule and Budget are not required</i> <i>Submission: within 48 hours of Week 13 Class (Link on Blackboard)</i>		

IV. Materials

In this subject you will be using learning materials written by the English Language Centre. Subject materials can be downloaded from LEARN@PolyU. Make sure that you bring the relevant learning materials to every class. The schedule in Section III is a guide to the materials you will need for each lesson.

V. Subject completion requirement

To successfully complete the subject, you have to complete all assessments as stated in Section VIII.

Failure to meet this requirement will result in an overall fail grade of the subject, and you will have to re-take the subject.

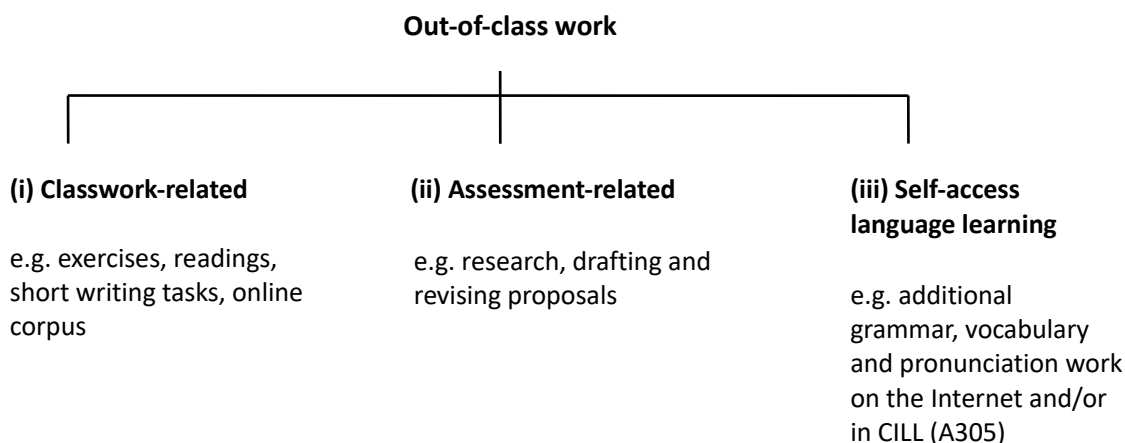
If you have taken this subject previously (either in whole or in part), you must inform your teacher as early as possible.

VI. Attendance and punctuality

You are required to attend at least 80% of the classes and to be punctual for all lessons. Failure to meet the attendance and punctuality requirements normally incurs a deduction from the overall subject grade. This deduction would be 1 sub-grade or more, depending on the degree of unsatisfactory attendance.

VII. Out-of-class work

In line with PolyU policy, you are expected to do 52 hours of out-of-class work for a two-credit subject. This means that, in addition to the 2 hours of classroom learning, you are expected to do at least 4 hours of out-of-class work in each of the 13 weeks of the subject. This includes classwork-related, assessment-related and self-access work.



VIII. Assessments

There are **three** assessments that evaluate your achievement of the learning outcomes of this subject. You are required to complete both Assessments 1 and 2 to pass the subject. The following regulations apply to this subject and to all ELC assessments.

Absence from in-class assessments

1. You must inform the teacher as early as possible if there are circumstances causing you to be absent from an in-class assessment. If the reason is judged to be acceptable, a make-up assessment will be arranged within ten calendar days of the original assessment date.
2. If you are absent from an in-class assessment without informing the teacher in advance, you must contact the teacher within **24 hours of the assessment** with an explanation for the absence. You must provide supporting documents (e.g. a doctor's note) for the absence **within 7 calendar days** after the assessment. Providing the explanation and supporting documents are judged acceptable, a make-up assessment will be arranged within ten calendar days of the original assessment date.
3. No make-up assessment will be given if you are absent from an in-class assessment without an acceptable reason and supporting documents. **In such cases, you will be considered to have not taken the assessment and will fail the subject.**

Late submission of out-of-class assessments

1. You must inform the teacher as early as possible if there are reasons for you to submit an out-of-class assessment after the deadline.
2. Late submissions, although accepted **within 3 calendar days** after the deadline, are subject to the following downgrading penalties:
 - by 1 sub-grade if the assessment is submitted within 24 hours after the deadline
 - by 2 sub-grades if the assessment is submitted within 48 hours after the deadline
 - by 3 sub-grades if the assessment is submitted within 72 hours after the deadline
3. If you do not submit your assessment within 72 hours, then **you will be considered to have not taken the assessment and will fail the subject**.
4. If you believe that you have a valid reason for a late submission, such as you are suffering from a serious illness, you will not receive a penalty provided that sufficient documentary evidence is provided within 7 calendar days of the assessment submission deadline.
5. If you are absent and unable to attend or submit an assessment according to the schedule, you need to show the original document to your teacher.

Academic honesty and avoiding plagiarism

The University takes a very serious view against dishonesty and plagiarism in students' work, including in-class and out-of-class assessments. Dishonesty includes misrepresenting AI-generated work as your own. Dishonesty and plagiarised work will lead to downgrading or other disciplinary action as described in the Student Handbook.

Assessment	Timing	Weighting	Learning outcome assessed
1. Individual Video Portfolio	Submission: Within 48 hours of Week 6 Class	40%	1,2,3
2. Group Project Proposal	Submission: Within 48 hours of Week 13 Class	45%	1,2,3
3. Individual Milestone Achievements	Weeks 1-13	15%	1,2,3

Details of the assessments are in the Assessment Overview and Assessment Guides

Your ELC subject and GenAI tools

The ELC follows the [PolyU policy](#) with regard to the use of GenAI tools. In summary, students are accountable for their own work. You should refer to the assessment section of this Student Information Sheet to check when you may use GenAI tools in this subject.

Note: Relying too much on AI can mean that you do not meet the assessment requirements. This will lead to either a low grade or fail grade for an assessment.

Please refer to the [GenAI@ELC Resource Hub](#) for useful ideas about enhancing your language learning with GenAI tools.